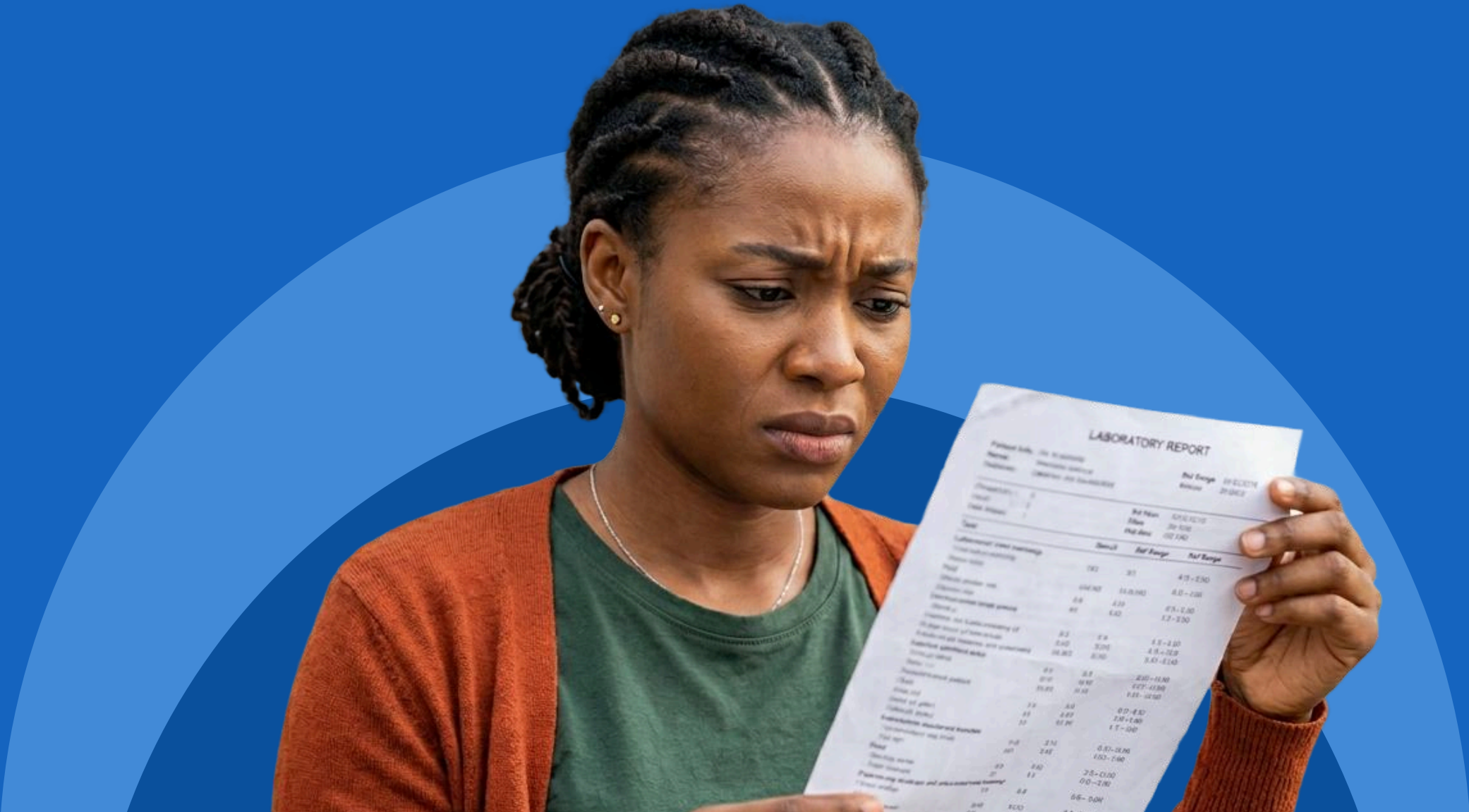


5

LAB VALUES EVERY
NIGERIAN SHOULD
UNDERSTAND



A Simple Guide to Taking Charge of Your Health



You paid for the test. You got the result. And then someone handed you a sheet of numbers and walked out.

That part, the part where someone explains what it means, is what this guide is for.

We've broken down [five lab tests every Nigerian should know about](#): what each one measures, what the numbers mean, and when it's worth a conversation with a doctor. It's also good preparation, the next time you're in front of a doctor, [you'll know what questions to ask](#).

This is also exactly why we're building [Clinsight](#), an app that reads your lab result and explains it back to you in plain language, in minutes. You're on our waitlist.

[The moment Clinsight goes live, we'll let you know.](#)

IMPORTANT NOTE ON "NORMAL" RANGES

Medical science has standard reference ranges for a healthy body, but individual labs fine-tune these slightly based on their own equipment. The difference is usually small, a point or two either way.

Your result sheet has its own [reference range](#) printed next to each value. That's the one that matters most for you. This guide focuses on the big picture, what it generally means when a value is high or low, rather than locking you into one exact number.

FULL BLOOD COUNT

1.

FULL BLOOD COUNT (FBC)

FULL
BLOOD

Also known as a [complete blood count \(CBC\)](#), the full blood count is a snapshot of your general health: how well your blood carries oxygen, how hydrated you are, and how your immune system is holding up.

 KEY PARAMETERS

Parameter	Typical Range	What It Means
Packed cell volume (PCV)	35–48%	Also called haematocrit. The percentage of your blood made up of red blood cells.
Haemoglobin (Hb)	12.0-16.0 g/dL	The protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen around your body.
Red Cell Count	$\approx 4.18 \times 10^{12}/L$	The total number of red blood cells in your blood.
White blood cell (WBC) count	$4.0\text{--}11.0 \times 10^9/L$	Your body's defence cells. A "differential" breaks this down by type, neutrophils (40–70%, respond to bacterial infections), lymphocytes (20–40%, respond to viral infections), monocytes (2–10%, clear damaged tissue), eosinophils (1–6%, respond to allergies and parasites), and basophils (0.5–1%, involved in allergic reactions).
Platelets	$150\text{--}450 \times 10^9/L$	The cells responsible for clotting your blood when you're injured.



Observation

What It Means For You

A low PCV or haemoglobin often points to anaemia , not enough oxygen-carrying capacity in your blood. An unusual white cell count usually reflects your body responding to infection or inflammation. If any FBC value falls outside your result sheet's reference range, it's worth a conversation with a doctor, the pattern across values tells a fuller story than any single number on its own.

FASTING & RANDOM

2.

**FASTING & RANDOM
BLOOD GLUCOSE
(Blood Sugar)**

BLOOD

GLUCOSE

This test measures the [amount of sugar in your bloodstream](#). Some sugar is essential fuel. Too much of it, over time, damages your blood vessels.

 KEY PARAMETERS

Parameter	Typical Range	What It Means
Fasting Blood Glucose (FBG)	70–99 mg/dL	Measured first thing in the morning, before you eat or drink anything.
Random Blood Glucose (RBG)	Generally below 140 mg/dL	Measured at any time of day, regardless of when you last ate. This range varies more than fasting glucose because it depends on your last meal, check your result sheet's own reference range.



Observation

What It Means For You

A fasting result between 100 and 125 mg/dL generally falls in the prediabetes range, higher than normal, but not yet diabetes. A fasting result at 126 mg/dL or above, confirmed on a second test, generally indicates diabetes. Either result is worth raising with a doctor soon.

ELECTRO
LYTES,
UREA,

3.

**E/U/Cr (Electrolytes,
Urea, and
Creatinine)**

CREAT
NE)

Your kidneys work like your [body's water treatment plant](#), filtering waste from everything you eat and drink and balancing your fluid and mineral levels. This test checks how well that filtration system is working.

 RENAL FUNCTIONS AND ELECTROLYTES

Parameter	Typical Range	What It Means
Sodium (Na ⁺)	136–145 mmol/L	Controls your fluid balance and nerve signalling.
Potassium (K ⁺)	3.5–5.1 mmol/L	Critical for how your heart beats and your muscles move.
Urea	10–35 mg/dL	A waste product from normal protein breakdown that your kidneys are supposed to flush away.
Creatinine	0.57–1.11 mg/dL	A waste product from normal muscle breakdown that your kidneys are supposed to flush away.



Observation

What It Means For You

Creatinine is often read alongside eGFR (estimated glomerular filtration rate, a measure of how well your kidneys filter). High creatinine alongside low eGFR is your kidneys signalling that something needs a closer look. It's not an emergency by itself, but it's worth discussing with a doctor.

URINALYSIS

4.

URINALYSIS (Urine Test)

URINALYSIS

A urinalysis uses a small urine sample to check on your [urinary tract, kidneys, and overall metabolic health](#), a lot of information from one simple test.

 KEY PARAMETERS GOTTEN FROM A URINALYSIS

Parameter	What It Means
pH and specific gravity	How acidic or concentrated your urine is. A high concentration often just means you need to drink more water.
Protein	Normally too large to pass through your kidney's filters. If it shows up, it can point to kidney inflammation, kidney damage, or high blood pressure stress (or pre-eclampsia, if you're pregnant).
Glucose and Ketones	Sugar isn't supposed to leak into urine. If it does, it usually points to elevated blood sugar.
Nitrites and leukocyte esterase	Waste products left behind by bacteria and white blood cells. Their presence usually points to a urinary tract infection (UTI) , which can come with symptoms like burning during urination or lower abdominal pain.

LIPID PROFILE

5.

LIPID PROFILE (Cholesterol Test)

(CHOL
ROL
TEST)

Your lipid profile measures the different types of fat travelling through your blood. Your body needs some fat to build healthy cells. Too much of the wrong kind, over time, can narrow your arteries.

 Lipid Profile

Parameter	Typical Range	What It Means
Total cholesterol	Below 200 mg/dL	The overall measure of all fats in your blood.
LDL (low-density lipoprotein)	Below 100 mg/dL	Known as "bad" cholesterol, the kind that builds up in your artery walls.
HDL (high-density lipoprotein)	Above 50 mg/dL	Known as "good" cholesterol, it helps clear excess cholesterol from your blood.
Triglycerides	Below 150 mg/dL	A type of fat your body stores for energy.



Observation

What It Means For You

High LDL or high triglycerides, especially alongside low HDL, raise your risk of heart disease over time. A single result outside range isn't a diagnosis. It's information worth acting on, through diet, activity, or a conversation with a doctor about next steps.

**WANT TO
STOP
GUESSING
WHAT YOUR
RESULTS
MEAN?**



You shouldn't need a medical degree to understand your own body.

When Clinsight launches, you'll upload a lab result and get a plain-language breakdown in minutes, what each marker means, what's normal, and what's worth a doctor's attention. No copying confusing terms into Google at 2 a.m. No walking into an appointment more anxious than when you left.

You're on the list. Keep an eye on your inbox, we'll email your download link and notify you the moment Clinsight goes live.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU GO

This guide is educational. Clinsight explains what your results show. It does not diagnose. **Nothing here should be used to start, stop, or change any medication, and if anything in this guide points you toward a real concern, that's exactly the moment to bring it to a doctor.**

Join the Clinsight WhatsApp community to be among the first to test the app:

<https://chat.whatsapp.com/CMZOtpPcH6z7Clyle3L66L>



REFERENCES FOR FURTHER READING

If you wish to read deeper into these parameters, you can explore these online resources:

[American Society of Hematology \(Blood Basics\)](#)

[Kidney Function Parameters](#)

<https://www.mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/heart-disease/in-depth/heart-disease/art-20049357>

<https://newsnetwork.mayoclinic.org/discussion/mayo-clinic-minute-5-things-your-blood-can-tell-you-about-your-health/>